

European Semiconductors

Inventory 2Q26: Benign inventories indicate continued strength in semi-conductor stocks

- Inventory position indicates an environment that continues to be supportive of a continuing up-cycle in the sector:** Semi-conductor inventory increased 5.6% QoQ in absolute dollar terms in 2Q26. However, inventory days were reduced to 136 days vs. 140 days at the end of Q1'26. On a seasonally-adjusted basis, overall semi-conductor days of inventory stood 1.5% below normal seasonal levels (three-year seasonal average) exiting 2Q26, higher than the 5.5% below average seen at the end of Q1'26. Semi-conductor ex-memory inventory increased by 4.8% QoQ in dollar terms, with days of inventory decreasing to 143 days vs. 147 days in 1Q26. On a seasonally-adjusted basis, semi-conductor ex-memory inventory stood 5.0% above the three-year seasonal average exiting 2Q26, compared to 4.5% above exiting 1Q26. Thus overall, despite the strong semi-conductor revenue growth, inventory in the sector remains in check and there is no indication of over-building, enabling the up-cycle to continue.
- Distributor inventories are very low driving re-stocking, memory inventory remains below seasonal, EMS, assembly and test inventories are also below seasonal. Wireless remains the weakest link:** Distributor days decreased to 59 days at the end of 2Q26 vs. 61 days at the end of 1Q26, which is 20.5% below three-year seasonality. *The low level of distributor inventories is likely to engender continued restocking that will help semi-conductor company sales.* Inventory at auto/industrial-exposed companies decreased from 173 days in 1Q26 to 163 days in 2Q26. On a seasonally-adjusted basis, 2Q days of inventory were 3.4% below the three-year seasonal average vs. 3.6% above seasonal levels in 1Q26. Thus, this key European end market is also improving. At Automotive and Industrial OEMs, although auto OEMs increased slightly, this is likely due to re-stocking – inventory days rose from 58 days in 1Q26 to 61 days in 2Q26, and stood 1.6% above three-year seasonal average levels compared to 2.2% below seasonality exiting 1Q26, while at industrial OEMs inventory days declined from 102 days in 1Q26 to 99 days in 2Q26, and stood 3.1% below three-year seasonal average levels compared to 2.7% below seasonality exiting 1Q26. The wireless market is the only one with cautious trends – inventory days rose from 139 in 1Q26 to 149 in 2Q26, standing 5.5% above three-year seasonal average levels compared to 2.4% above seasonality exiting 1Q26.
- Sector-specific indicators indicate continued stock price performance:** Despite semi-conductor growth that was very high, up 35.3% QoQ and 124% YoY, semiconductor inventories remain under control with key segments such as distributors continuing to have below normal inventories. Memory inventory remains 14% below the seasonal average and auto/industrial semi-conductor inventory is below normal levels. With the inventory picture really benign and no indications of any of the key semi-conductor indicators deteriorating, we believe that the reports and the guidance from semi-conductor companies should continue to be strong in the October results. With the shortages in the semi space continuing, we remain bullish on most of the large cap semi-conductor stocks in our space. ASML (OW, AFL) and ASMI (OW) are our key picks in the space, and we are also bullish on Infineon (OW), VAT (OW) and Besi (OW) in the large cap space.

European Tech Hardware & Payments

Sandeep Deshpande ^{AC}

(44-20) 7134-5276
sandeep.s.deshpande@jpmorgan.com

Craig A McDowell

(44-20) 7742-4576
craig.mcdowell@jpmorgan.com
J.P. Morgan Securities plc

Specialist Sales contact details:

Scott Silver - Specialist Sales - European TMT

(44-20) 7134-0412
scott.silver@jpmorgan.com

Also published today is our Q2'26 review for SMID Cap stocks, including our latest order of preference in the space ([link](#))

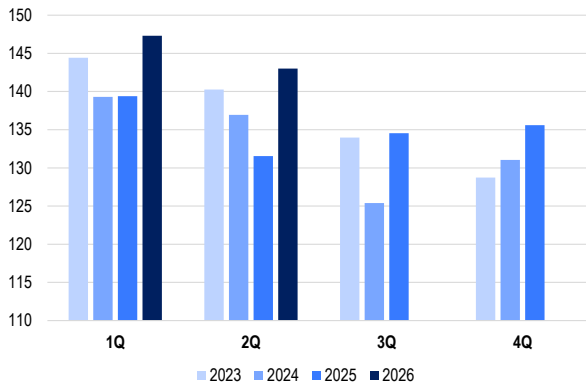
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24 August 2026

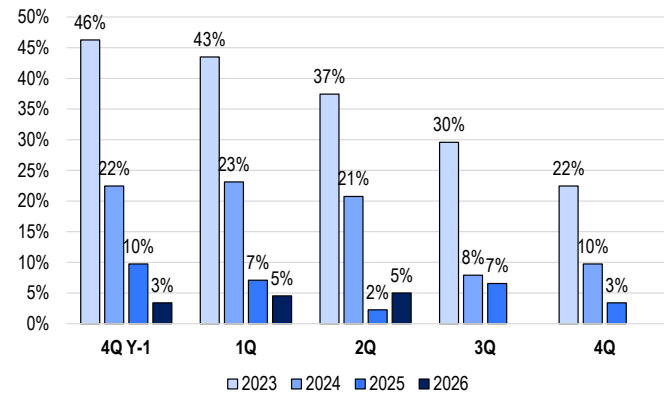
Semiconductor Quarterly Data Snapshot

Figure 1: Semiconductor ex. memory inventory days



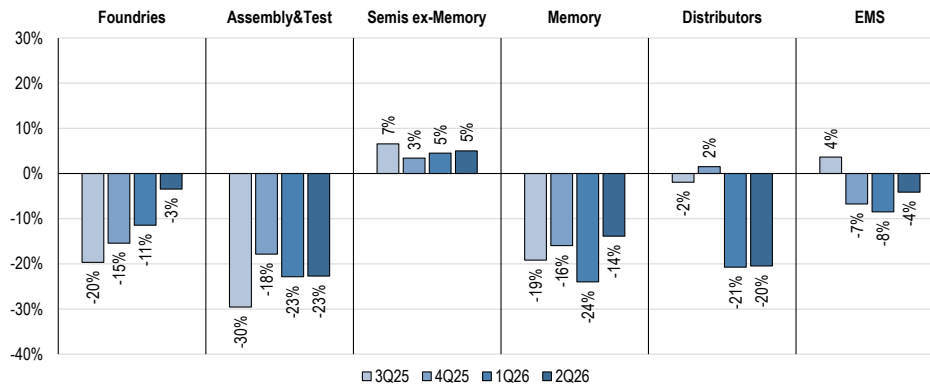
Source: J.P. Morgan, Company reports

Figure 2: Semiconductor ex. memory seasonally-adjusted inventory levels



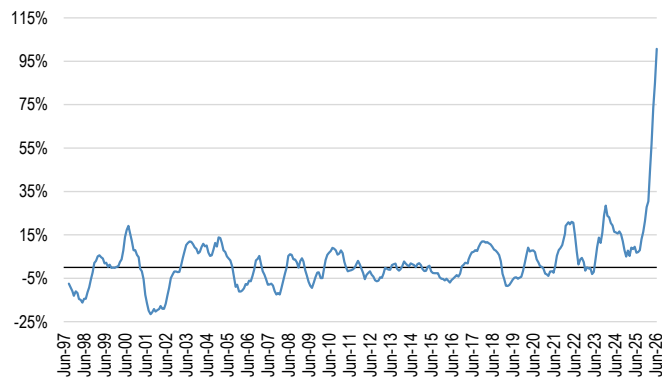
Source: J.P. Morgan, Company reports

Figure 3: Inventory wrt 3-year seasonal average



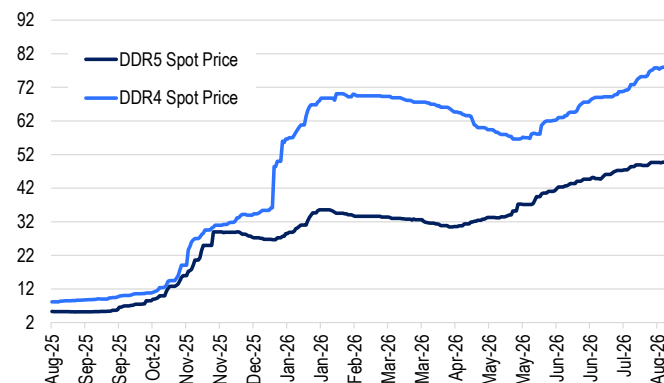
Source: Company reports.

Figure 4: Overall semi-conductor ASP YoY (3MMA, %)



Source: WSTS.

Figure 5: DRAM Spot Price Index



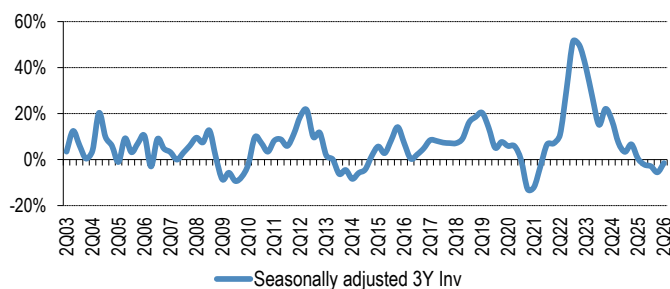
Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P., InSpectrum.

Overall semi inventories increased in \$ terms but decreased in DOI terms

Overall, semi-conductor inventory increased 5.6% QoQ in absolute dollar terms in 2Q26, with inventory at 136 days (vs. 140 days at the end of Q1'26 and 131 days at the end of Q4'25). On a seasonally-adjusted basis, overall semi-conductor days of inventory stood 1.5% below normal seasonal levels (three-year seasonal average) exiting 2Q26, higher than the 5.5% below average seen at the end of Q1'26.

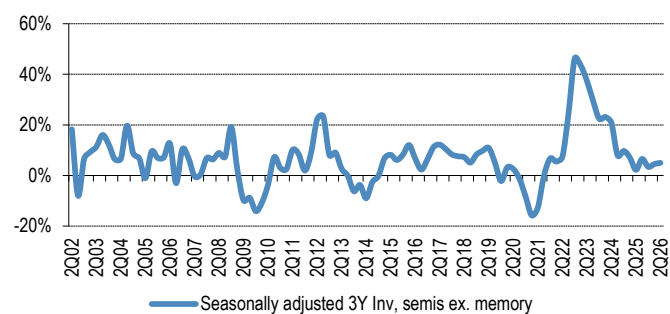
Semi-conductor ex-memory inventory increased by 4.8% QoQ in dollar terms, with days of inventory decreasing to 143 days (vs 147 days in 1Q26). On a seasonally-adjusted basis, semi-conductor ex-memory inventory stood 5.0% above the three-year seasonal average exiting 2Q26, compared to 4.5% above exiting 1Q26.

Figure 6: Overall semis inventory wrt 3-year seasonal average



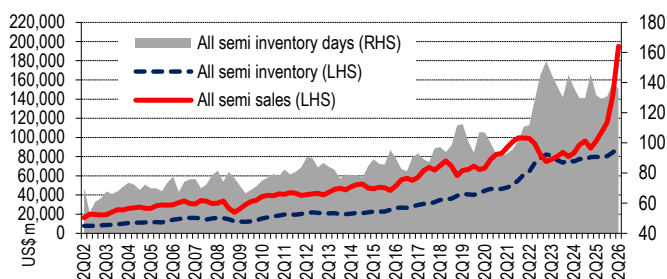
Source: Company reports.

Figure 8: Semis ex-memory inventory wrt 3-year seasonal average



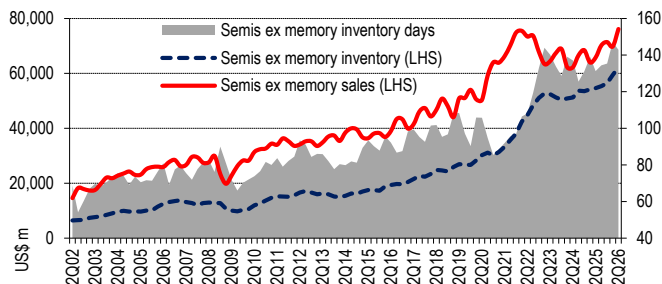
Source: Company reports.

Figure 7: Overall semis sales and inventory



Source: Company reports.

Figure 9: Overall semis ex-memory sales and inventory



Source: Company reports.

IDM inventory remains benign, fabless inventory rising but distorted by one company

IDM inventory at the end of 2Q26 was up 0.4% QoQ in absolute dollar terms, with days of inventory down to 143 days compared to 157 days in 1Q25, which implies DOI was 4.1% below the three-year average seasonality.

In 2Q26, Fabless inventory increased 10.3% QoQ in absolute dollar terms, and inventory increased to 144 days exiting 2Q26 (from 134 days exiting 1Q26) – this stood 9.4% above the three-year seasonal average as compared to the 2.8% above the seasonal average exiting 1Q26. This was mostly driven by a strong increase in inventory at Qualcomm with DOI increasing from 137 days to 164 days in 2Q26 from an increase in WIP inventory. The company assigns this inventory build to customer demand impacts from memory supply constraints. Excluding Qualcomm, fabless inventory rose 8.1% QoQ in \$ terms and inventory days rose only slightly to 133 days in 2Q26, from 132 days in 1Q26.

Figure 10: Fabless inventory days

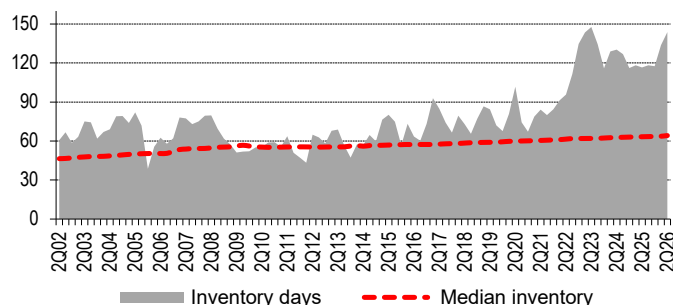
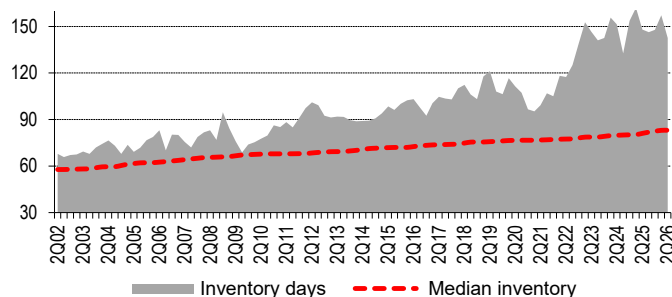
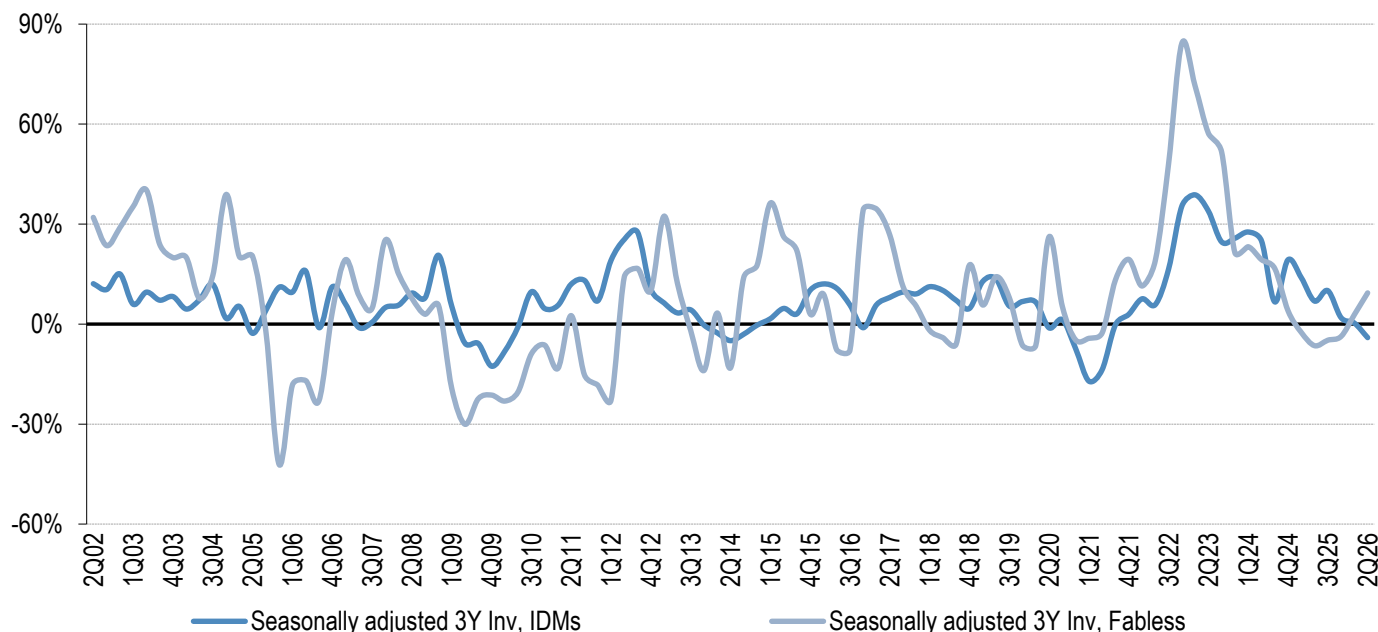


Figure 11: IDM inventory days



Source: Company reports.

Figure 12: Semiconductor inventory wrt 3-year seasonal average (IDMs vs. Fabless)



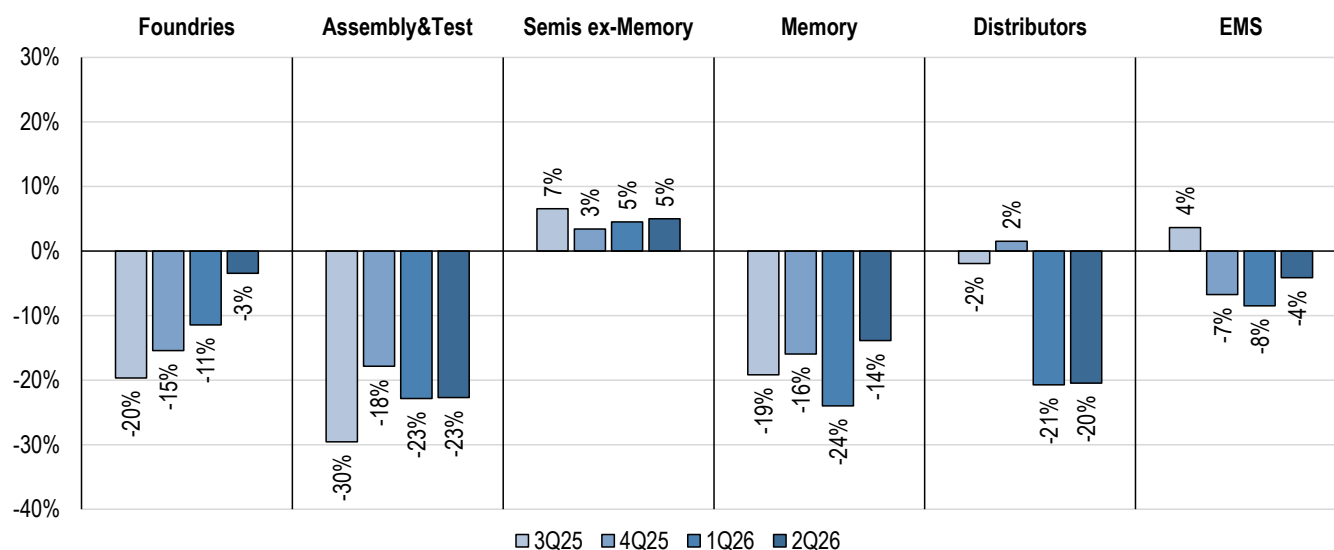
Source: Company reports

Inventory position across the semi-conductor value chain

Key take-aways from the inventory data across the semiconductor supply chain are:

- Memory players included in our calculation (Samsung is excluded) reported higher inventories in 2Q26 but significantly below three-year seasonality, with inventory up 7.4% QoQ in absolute dollar terms, which represented 122 days of inventory vs 126 days in 1Q26. Memory inventory stood at 14% below three-year average seasonality.
- Assembly & Testing inventory remains depressed, with inventory days standing at 36 days (38 days at the end of 1Q26). Absolute inventory was up 2.7% sequentially, which is 22.7% below three-year seasonality.
- Distributor inventory days decreased to 59 days at the end of 2Q26 (vs. 61 days at the end of 1Q26), which is 20.5% below three-year seasonality.

Figure 13: Inventory wrt 3-year seasonal average

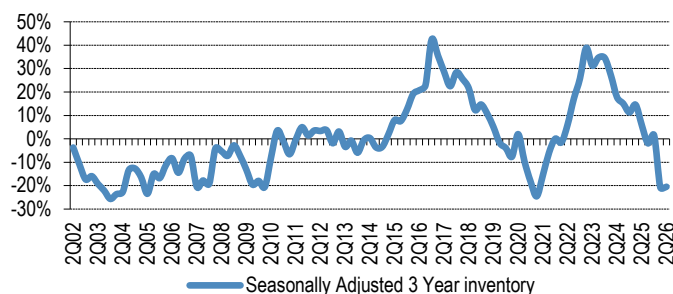


Source: Company reports.

Distributor inventory thinning

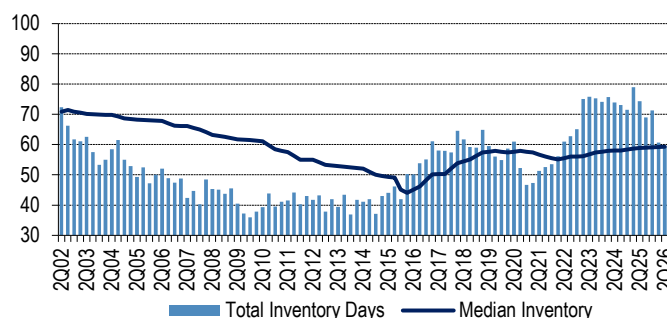
Distributor inventory down again in 2Q26 from lower levels: Distributors (comprising Avnet, Arrow, WT Micro and Macnica) days of inventory stood at 59 days exiting 2Q26, 20.5% below the three-year seasonal average, compared to 61 days and 20.7% below average exiting 1Q26. Distributor inventory increased 12.9% on an absolute basis and but days of inventory decreased by 2 days (with COGS and sales increasing ~15% QoQ driven by strong activity). Overall, industry comments point to channel and distribution inventory being very lean, which would mean that re-stocking is likely to continue.

Figure 14: Seasonally adjusted distributor inventory



Source: Company reports.

Figure 15: Distributor inventory

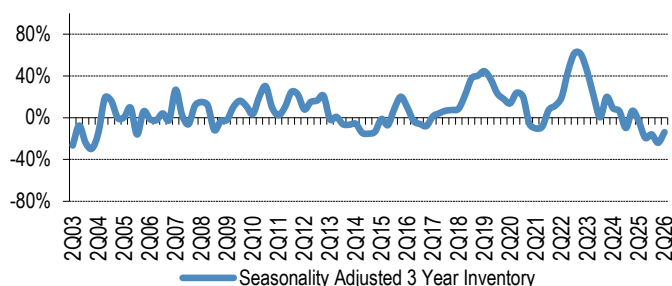


Source: Company reports.

Memory inventory below seasonality, in line with strong up-cycle

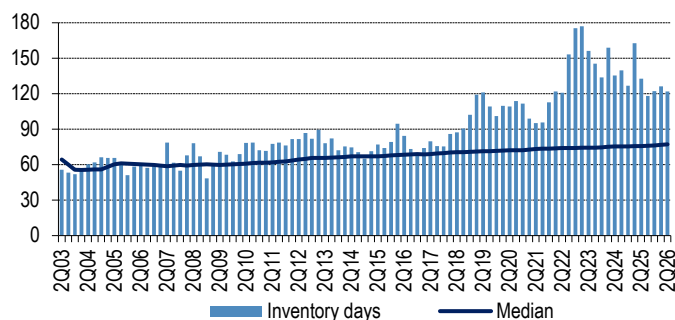
Semi-conductor memory inventory days below seasonality: Days of inventory at memory companies (including Micron, Nanya, Winbond, Kioxia and SanDisk) stood at 122 days exiting 2Q26 (vs. 126 days exiting 1Q26), 14% below the three-year seasonal average vs. 24% below normal exiting 1Q26. Memory inventories have declined significantly from their peak and inventories will likely continue to be lower given supply tightness in memory devices.

Figure 16: Seasonally-adjusted memory inventory



Source: Company reports.

Figure 17: Memory inventory data

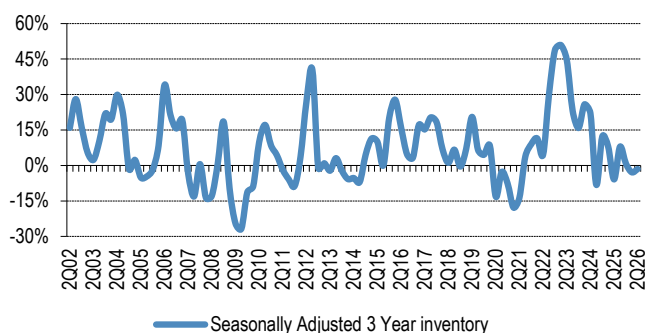


Source: Company reports.

Server/PC component inventory continues to be volatile

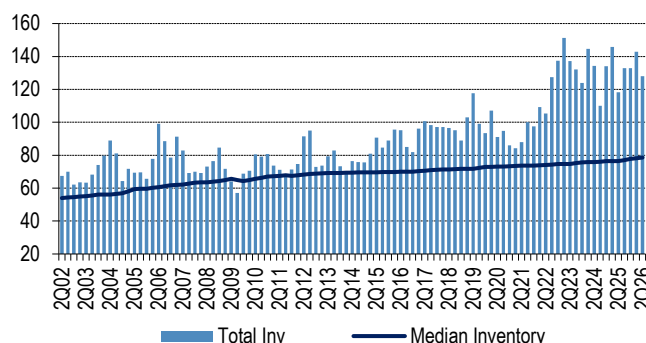
Server/PC component inventory below seasonal: PC component inventory (comprising Intel and AMD) increased 2.4% QoQ in 2Q26, but days of inventory were 1.5% above the three-year seasonal average as compared to 2.9% below exiting 1Q26.

Figure 18: Server/PC component inventory



Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P.

Figure 19: Server/PC component inventory days

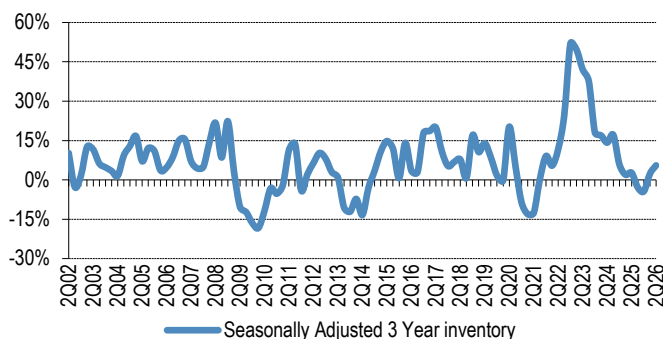


Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P.

Wireless component inventory increasing on potentially weaker demand

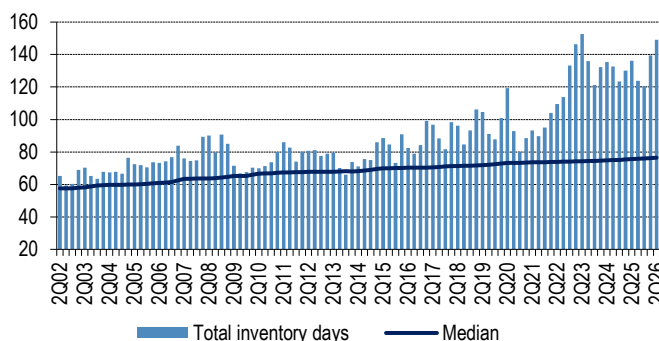
Wireless component days of inventory increased above seasonal levels: Wireless component inventory increased 7.8% QoQ in absolute terms and inventory days were not better, rising from 139 days in 1Q26 to 149 days in 2Q26, standing 5.5% above three-year seasonal average levels compared to 2.4% above seasonality exiting 1Q26.

Figure 20: Wireless semi-conductor inventory



Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P.

Figure 21: Wireless semi-conductor inventory days

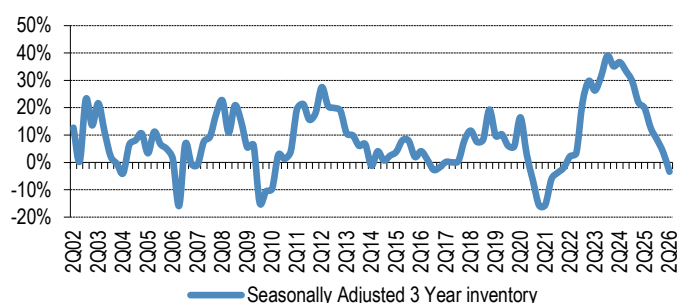


Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P.

Inventory at auto/industrial-exposed semi companies improving and now below seasonal levels

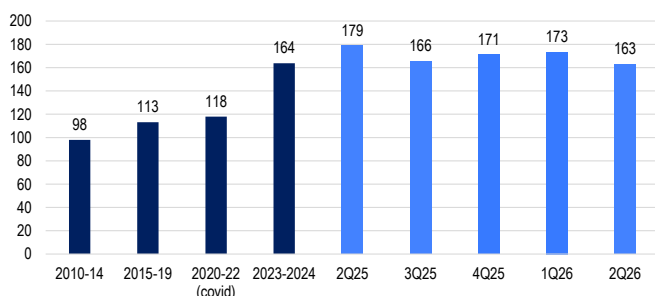
Inventory at auto/industrial-exposed companies in 2Q26 increased 1.7% in absolute terms, but days of inventory decreased from 173 days in 1Q26 to 163 days in 2Q26. On a seasonally-adjusted basis, 2Q days of inventory were 3.4% below the three-year seasonal average vs. 3.6% above seasonal levels in 1Q26. Companies have been maintaining higher inventories in preparation for an up-cycle. Some companies are now targeting lower levels of inventory to improve cash conversion (Infineon).

Figure 22: Seasonally-adjusted inventory level at auto/industrial-exposed companies



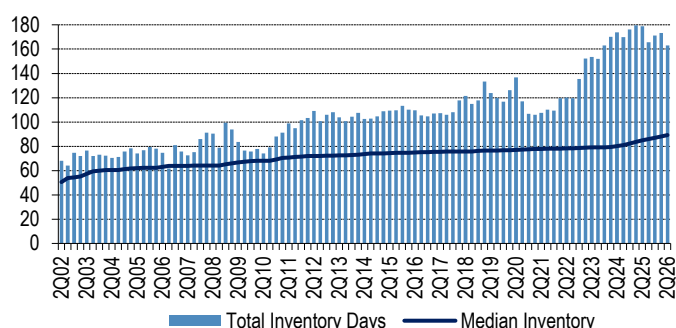
Source: Company reports.

Figure 24: Autos/Industrial Semis – average days of inventory



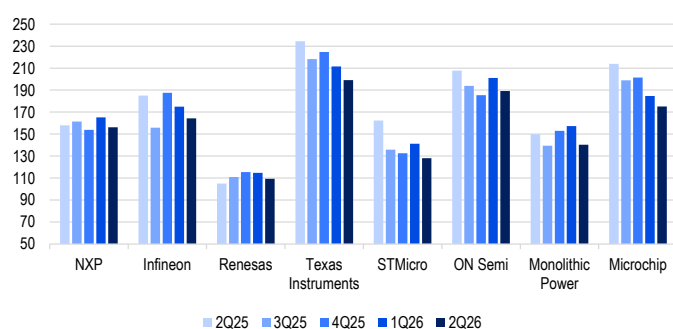
Source: Company reports.

Figure 23: Inventory days at auto/industrial-exposed companies



Source: Company reports.

Figure 25: Selected Autos/Industrial semis, days of inventory

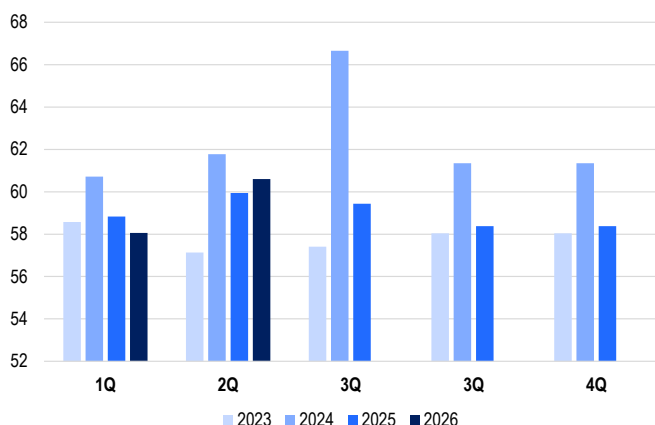


Source: Company reports.

Inventory at auto parts suppliers and industrial companies

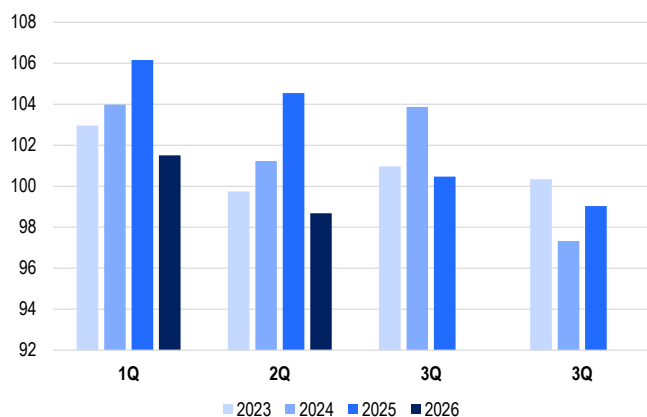
In this section, we analyse inventories at auto parts suppliers and industrial companies. Overall, the inventory situation looks more favourable for industrial companies with inventories significantly down in 2Q26. Automotive suppliers' inventories, however, have been increasing again after a better Q1 broadly, possibly because they face pressure to re-stock due to the risk of not getting chips given the strength in the AI market.

Figure 26: Auto suppliers' inventory days (excluding BYD)



Source: J.P. Morgan, Company reports

Figure 27: Industrials inventory days

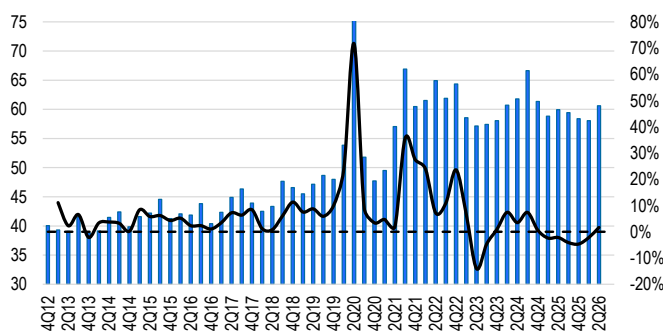


Source: J.P. Morgan, Company reports.

Auto parts suppliers

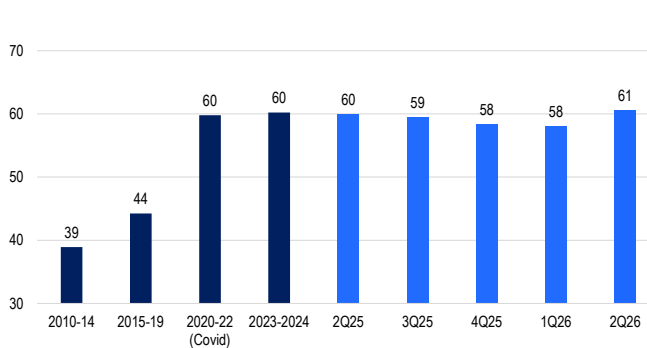
Auto suppliers' inventory increased 0.7% QoQ in absolute terms and inventory days rose from 58 days in 1Q26 to 61 days in 2Q26 and stood 1.6% above three-year seasonal average levels compared to 2.2% *below* seasonality exiting 1Q26.

Figure 28: Auto suppliers – days of inventory



Source: Company reports.

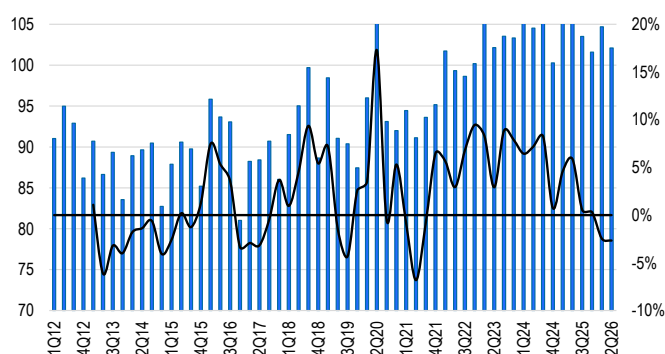
Figure 29: Auto suppliers – average days of inventory



Industrials

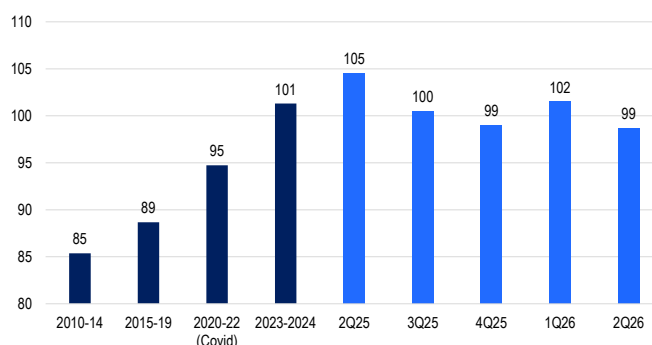
Industrials inventory increased 2.7% QoQ in absolute terms but inventory days declined from 102 days in 1Q26 to 99 days in 2Q26, and stood 3.1% below three-year seasonal average levels compared to 2.7% below seasonality exiting 1Q26.

Figure 30: Industrials – days of inventory



Source: Company reports.

Figure 31: Industrial – average days of inventory



Source: Company reports.

Channel inventory comments by auto/industrial exposed semi companies

Table 1: Channel inventory indications at auto/industrial semi companies

Company	Channel inventory	Details
NXP	11 weeks (target)	Channel inventory at appropriate level for servicing customers. Majority of Asian auto customers served through distribution; Western Tier 1s tracked directly. No restocking observed – inventory digestion behind, company shipping to real end demand with no pull-forwards. Late orders indicate some auto customers still operating hand-to-mouth.
Infineon	Inventory de-stocked	Inventories largely de-stocked across markets, becoming a growth driver for Infineon.
STMicro	Below standard target	Distribution inventory decreased further and is now below the standard target and co. indicates a healthy channel position.
Renesas	Absolute channel inventory up QoQ but days of inventory declined	Channel inventory rose in absolute terms but week of inventory (WOI) fell on a significant increase in sell-through. Unable to build auto/IoT inventory in Q2 despite demand; plans to increase in Q3 with WOI still expected to decline as sell-through rises. H2 focus on enhancing auto and IIoT inventory, mainly around data centre where strong demand keeps WOI trending down.
Microchip	25 days (low end)	Distribution inventory was at 25 days, down one day and at the lower end of historical experience -> replenishment is expected in coming quarters. Distributors at the low end of the historical range want to return to normal but are waiting on customer orders before replenishing; frustrated that customers aren't placing longer-term orders despite lead-time and AI-capacity warnings
Onsemi	10.1 weeks (down QoQ)	Distribution inventory declined to 10.1 weeks. Onsemi is not seeing an inventory build at customers – shipping to end demand in auto/industrial with a disciplined, KPI-based approach

Source: Company reports.

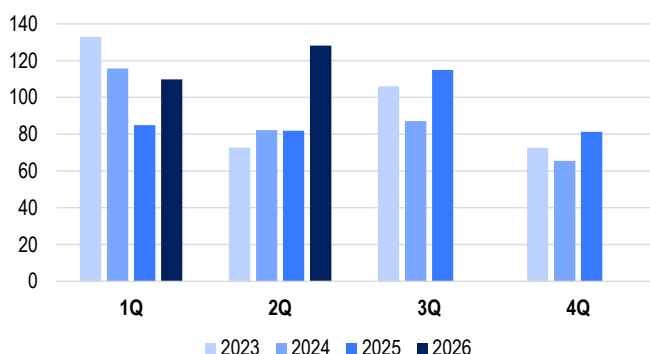
Inventory at AI-exposed OEM/ODMs

Overall, inventory is rising at AI exposed OEM and ODMs both for servers and networking. Strategically, companies are building inventory in anticipation of higher revenues going into 2H26. We would also note that in an inflationary AI component environment, companies can benefit from building inventory which can increase in value over time/secure components at lower prices.

Inventory at AI server OEMs and ODM

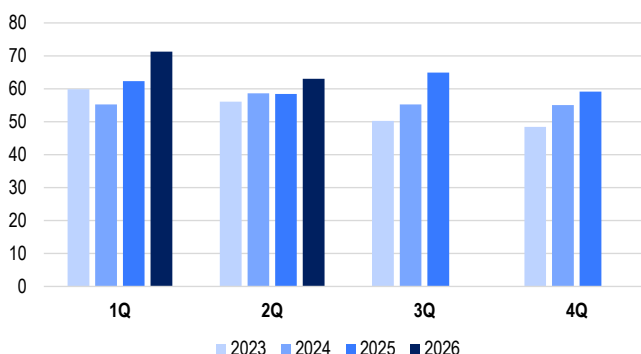
Inventory at AI server OEMs has risen significantly in 2Q26 (+16% QoQ in absolute terms, +16.7% in inventory days) and is well above 3Y seasonality. Inventory at AI server ODMs has also declined 11.5% QoQ in inventory days but stood 9.3% above 3Y seasonality.

Figure 32: AI server OEMs inventory days



Source: Company reports, J.P. Morgan.

Figure 33: AI server ODMs inventory days

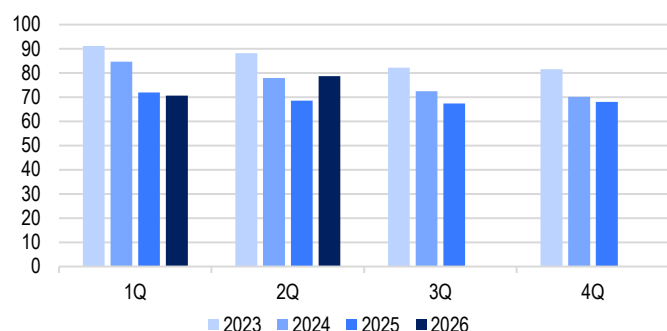


Source: Company reports, J.P. Morgan.

Inventory at AI networking ODM/OEMs

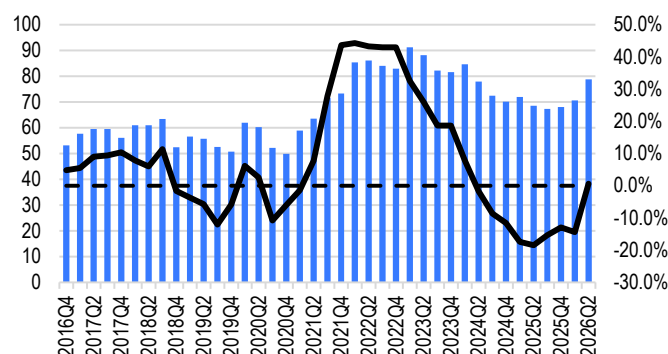
Inventory at AI networking ODM/OEMs have risen 18% QoQ and 11.4% in inventory days. They stood at 0.6% above 3Y seasonality.

Figure 34: AI networking ODM/OEM/JDM inventory days



Source: Company reports, J.P. Morgan.

Figure 35: AI networking ODM/OEM/JDM inventory days and 3Y seasonally-adjusted variation

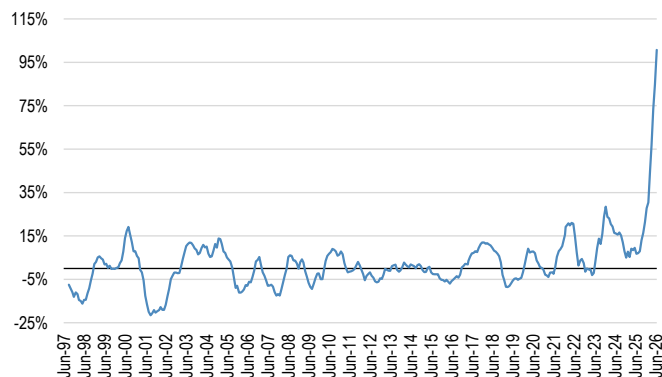


Source: Company reports, J.P. Morgan.

Overall semi and semis ex-memory pricing continues to rise

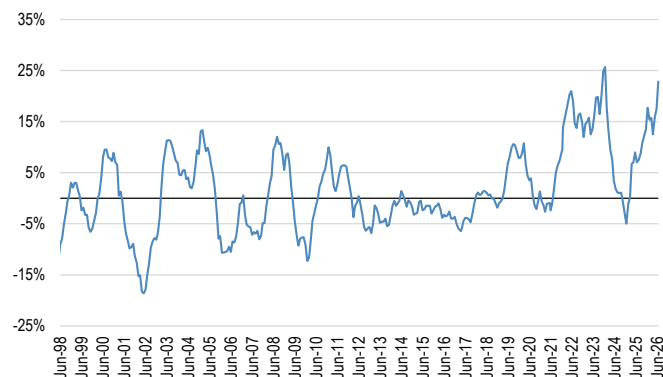
Overall, semi pricing (on a 3MMA basis) was up 100.7% YoY in June 2026, from being up 85%/73.4% in May/April '26, respectively. Semi ex memory pricing is up 22.8% YoY in June 2026, from being up 17.6%/15.8% YoY in May/April '26.

Figure 36: Semi ASP continues to be up on YoY basis



Source: WSTS. Updated to June 2026.

Figure 37: YoY increase in semi-ex memory pricing

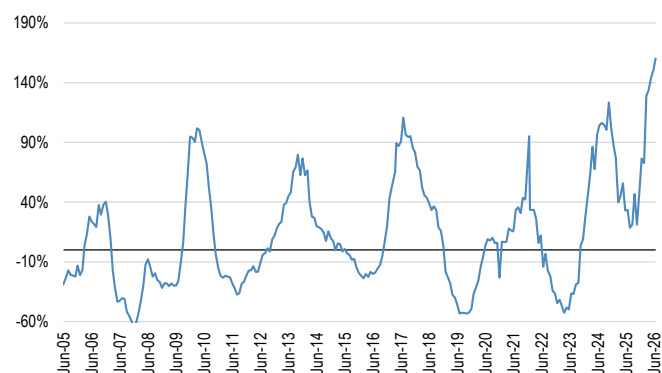


Source: WSTS. Updated to June 2026.

Memory pricing still soaring

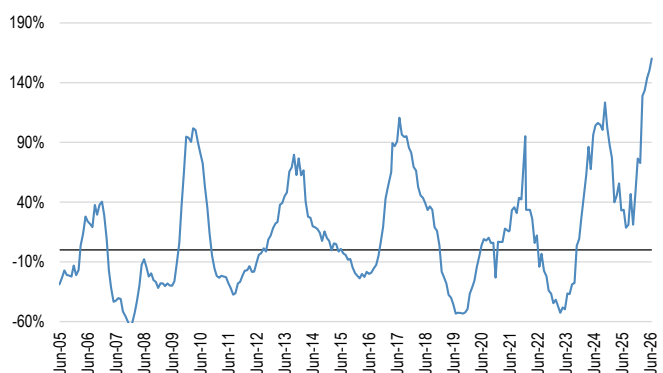
WSTS data shows parabolic growth in memory pricing. DRAM ASPs continue to grow and June 26 pricing data shows DRAM ASP increasing 160% YoY vs 150%/144% growth in May/April '26. NAND ASP is rising even faster with June '26 NAND ASP increasing 182% vs 170%/149% growth in May/April '26.

Figure 38: DRAM ASP YoY Growth (%)



Source: WSTS.

Figure 39: NAND ASP YoY Growth (%)



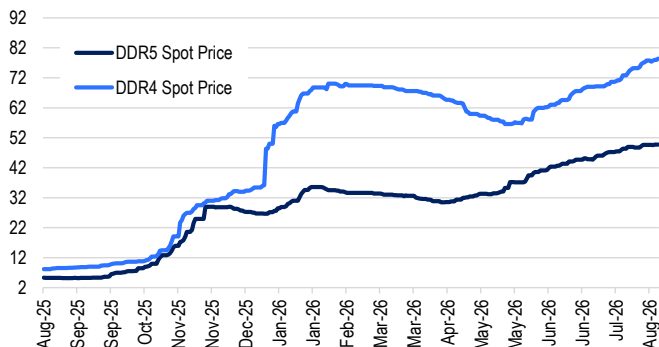
Source: WSTS.

Memory spot price keep increasing in DRAM, NAND essentially stable

DRAM spot prices continue to climb driven by strong AI demand and DRAM bit supply/demand gap is expected to persist (or even increase) in 2027. NAND spot prices have declined moderately from March/April peaks.

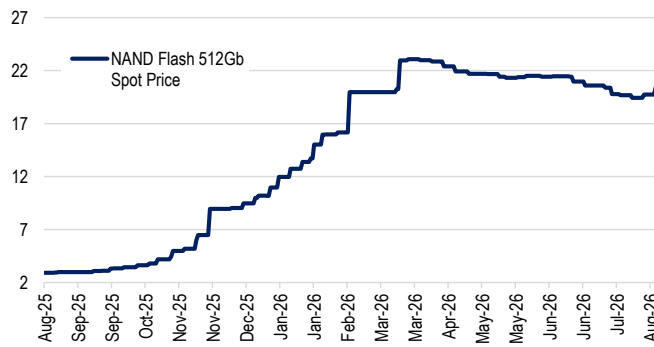
- Contract prices are still lagging spot price increases but memory makers are now securing significant part of their bit supply through LTAs. We note that DDR5 16GB contract prices are up 17.65% in the month of July alone, according to InSpectrum and DDR5 64GB RDIMM (server/data center module) is up 18.8% in the month of July (InSpectrum).

Figure 40: DRAM spot price



Source: InSpectrum, Bloomberg Finance L.P.

Figure 41: NAND spot price



Source: InSpectrum, Bloomberg Finance L.P.

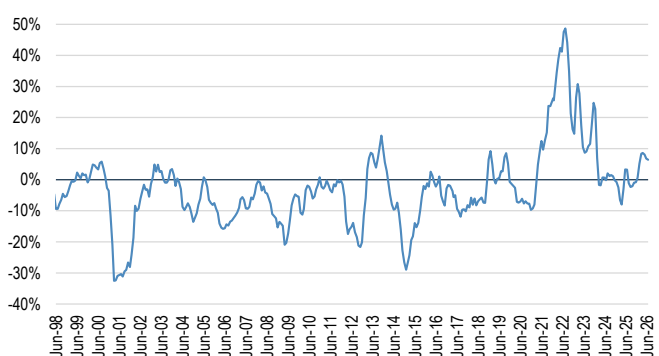
Power semis pricing remains negative; MCU pricing stabilising

European semi-conductor device majors, Infineon and semi-conductors.

cs are most exposed to micro-controllers and power

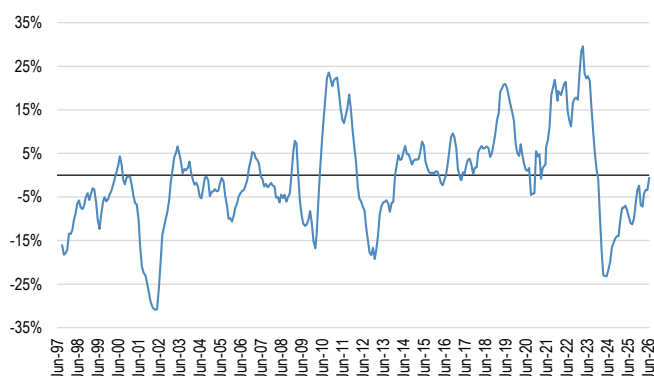
- **MCUs** ASP is up 6.4% in June'26 vs up 6.8%/8.1% in May/April '26 on a 3-month moving average basis. MCU pricing should be supported by new generation of MCUs consolidating several smaller micro-components for new architectures (zonal control units for instance) and a higher mix of high performance MCUs for AI data centres.
- **Power semi** is looking better, with pricing rising 6.3% YoY in June'26 (down 0.6% on a 3MMA basis) after a long downcycle. This is driven by power MOSFETs pricing being up 11% in June'26 with several players raising prices driven by AI power semis demand. Power IGBTs remain weak with pricing down 19% in June'26. We expect continued power MOSFET pricing strength from AI-driven demand.

Figure 42: Year-on-year change in ASP of micro-controller (MCU) chips



Source: WSTS. Updated to June 2026.

Figure 43: Year-on-year change in ASP of power semi-conductor chips



Source: WSTS. Updated to June 2026.

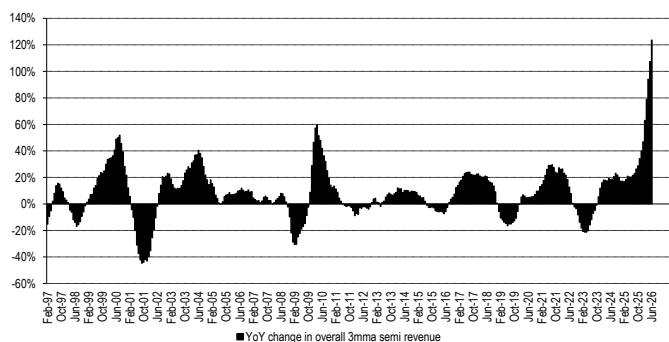
Semi sales accelerating in 2Q26

As per WSTS data, total 2Q26 semi sales were up 35.3% on a QoQ basis, with the sequential trend ahead of the normal seasonal growth of 5.6% seen on average in the past 5 years. On a YoY basis, total 2Q26 semis sales were up 124% YoY vs 78.8% YoY in 1Q26.

Total semi-conductor sales excluding memory and discrete products (semis ex-memory ex-discrete) were up 10.6% QoQ (vs. up 2.6% on average according to five-year seasonality). On a YoY basis, 2Q26 semis ex-memory ex-discrete sales were up 36.1% compared to up 28.5% YoY in 1Q26.

In the reported data for June 2026, total semi-conductor sales increased 10.5% MoM and increased 134% on a YoY basis. In unit terms, total semi-conductor units in June 2026 were up 8.2% YoY.

Figure 44: YoY change in overall 3mma semi revenue



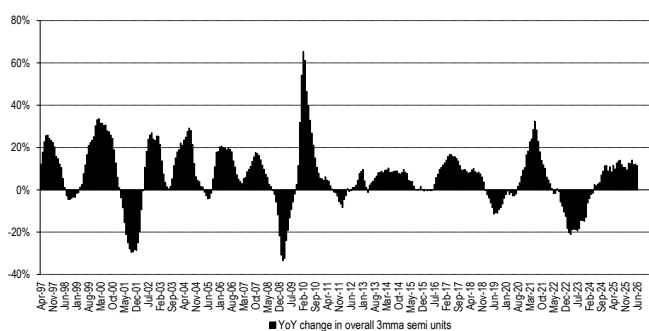
Source: WSTS. Updated to June 2026.

Memory sales very strong

Memory sales in 2Q26 were up 64.2% QoQ, significantly above the 5Y seasonality of a 17% QoQ decline. On a YoY basis, 2Q26 memory sales were up 363%.

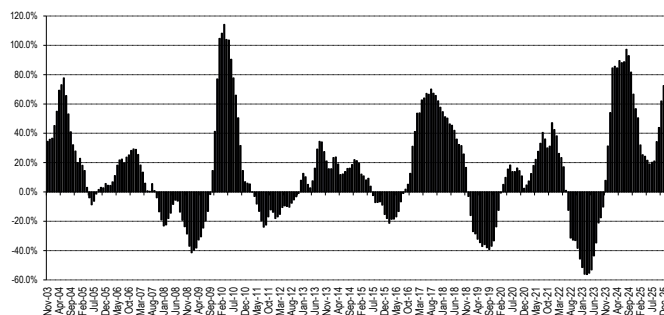
March'26 memory sales were up 11% MoM and 369% YoY, highlighting the strength of the memory cycle. This was driven almost entirely by higher pricing (+225% YoY) with unit growth of 44.4% YoY.

Figure 45: YoY change in overall 3mma semi units



Source: WSTS. Updated to June 2026.

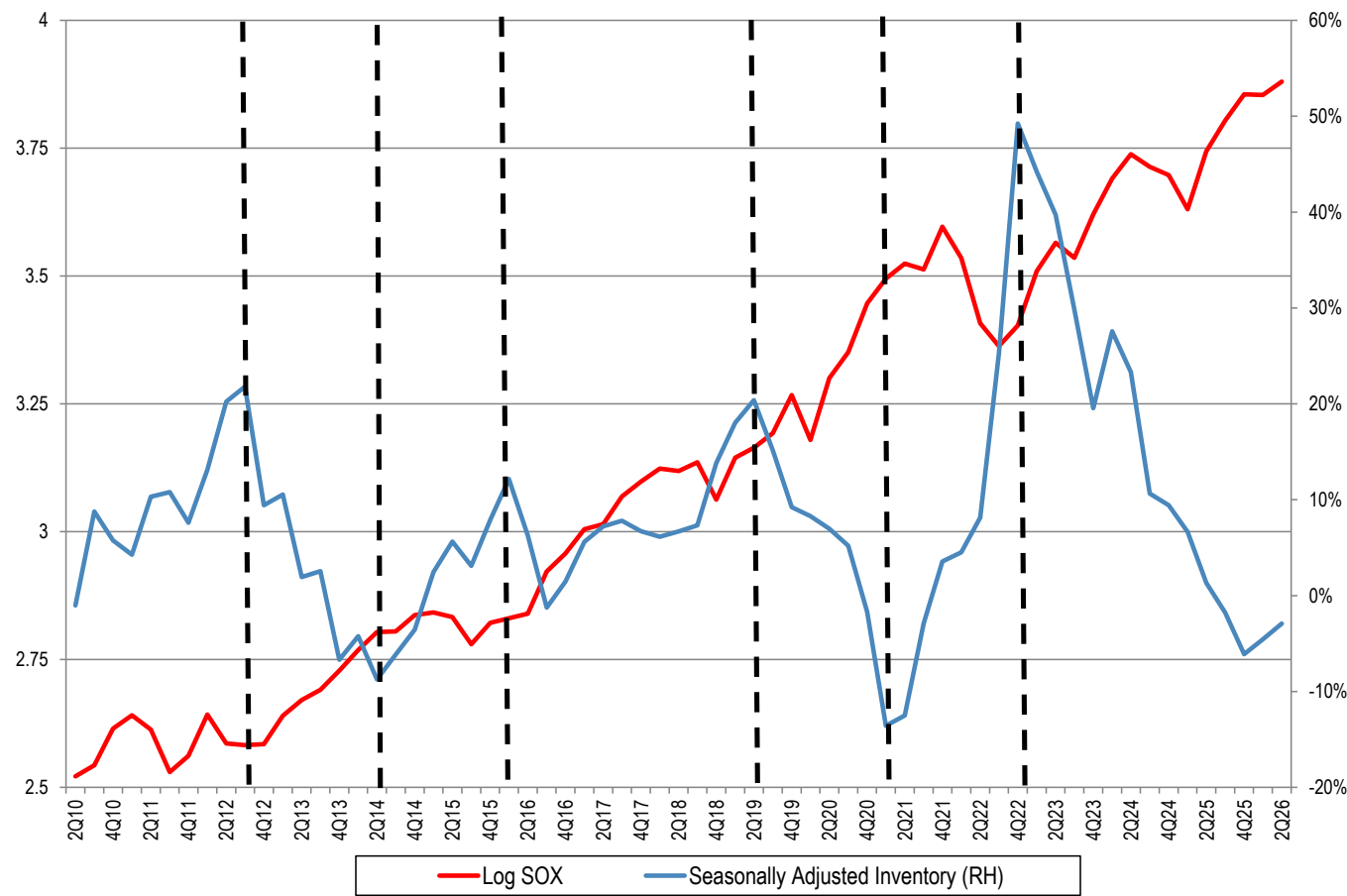
Figure 46: Memory revenue YoY growth (%)



Source: WSTS.

Semi inventory and SOX

Figure 47: SOX and inventory



Source: SOX and company data

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